

module-03-ayurveda-good-health - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 3 — Āyurveda and Good Health (Darśana)

Sanskrit: Āyurveda · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

The science of life — daily routine, diet, and well-being.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 3’s full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Project two side-by-side photos: (a) a modern busy office worker on a couch, (b) a person doing morning yoga at sunrise. “*Both are valid lives. But the second is closer to what Āyurveda recommends. Why?*” Brief discussion: rhythms, food, sleep, movement.

Core idea · 15 min

Āyurveda framework, three pillars:

1. **Dinacarya** (daily routine) — sleep, wake, food times. Aligning with sun/circadian rhythm.
2. **Ahāra** (diet) — the *ṣaḍ-rasa* (six tastes): sweet, sour, salty, pungent, bitter, astringent. Each meal should include several tastes; not just sweet.
3. **Tridoṣa** (three constitutions) — *vāta* (motion), *pitta* (transformation), *kapha* (structure). Everyone has all three; the ratio differs. **THIS IS A WELLNESS LENS, NOT DIAGNOSIS.**

Modern parallel: circadian rhythm research (Nobel 2017, Hall/Rosbash/Young) validates dinacarya logic.

Demonstration · 10 min

24-hour clock activity. Each student sketches their actual daily schedule (sleep, eat, school, exercise) on a circular 24-hour clock. Compare with the Āyurveda-recommended schedule. Identify 2 mismatches.

Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.41: “*The purpose of this Āyurveda is to maintain the health of the healthy and to relieve the disorders of the diseased.*” The order matters — prevention first, treatment second.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Six-taste meal design. Pairs design ONE meal that includes 4 of the 6 tastes. Use Indian ingredients. Present to class — explain which taste each ingredient brings.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“What’s ONE thing about your daily routine you’d change after this lesson? Why? What might get in the way?”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — What is Āyurveda? Definition + scope
- **Day 02** — Tridoṣa — vāta, pitta, kapha
- **Day 03** — Dinacarya — daily routine
- **Day 04** — Ahāra — food + the six tastes
- **Day 05** — R̥tucarya — seasonal eating
- **Day 06** — Sleep, exercise, elimination
- **Day 07** — Caraka, Suśruta, Vāgbhaṭa — the three Āyurveda authors
- **Day 08** — Bridge to modern science — circadian, microbiome
- **Day 09** — Critical reading — Āyurveda claims vs evidence
- **Day 10** — Synthesis: personal wellness plan + class share

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.